

Interrogation Record: Hesper Wrenfield

Repository: Ashen Era Testimony **Subject:** Hesper Wrenfield **Classification:** Outrider **Status:** Minor figure of the Ashen Era **Birth:** 404 AS

The following record is preserved without seal, witness-mark, or certifying hand. Several portions are smudged. Whether the words belong to the questioner, the subject, or the quill-bearer cannot be proved.

QUESTIONER: State your name.

HESPER WRENFIELD: Hesper Wrenfield.

QUESTIONER: Your station?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Outrider.

QUESTIONER: For whom do you ride?

[A pause is entered here. The line beneath is scratched through until the parchment is nearly pierced.]

HESPER WRENFIELD: For the road, when the road permits it.

QUESTIONER: That is not a power.

HESPER WRENFIELD: I did not say it was.

QUESTIONER: Have you carried word for the Ashen Vanguard?

HESPER WRENFIELD: I have carried words.

QUESTIONER: Have you carried word for House Morvain?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Words do not wear house colors when folded.

QUESTIONER: The Silent Choir?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Silence carries farther than either of us.

QUESTIONER: The Iron-Ring Cartel?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Ask the rings.

QUESTIONER: The Bleeding Crown?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Ask the crown.

[Here the questioner commands the subject to stand. No description of the subject's appearance is entered. The recorder notes that no canonical physical features are established for Hesper Wrenfield; their visual identity is limited to their role as an Outrider. No further likeness, height, scars, clothing, or coloring is supplied by this record.]

QUESTIONER: You were born in 404 AS. Confirm it.

HESPER WRENFIELD: If the ink insists.

QUESTIONER: The ink insists.

HESPER WRENFIELD: Then let it bear the burden.

QUESTIONER: What did you see beyond the ash line?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Ash.

QUESTIONER: What did you hear?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Hearing is a door. Doors are not confessions.

QUESTIONER: You mistake insolence for protection.

HESPER WRENFIELD: You mistake a record for truth.

[The recorder adds: No temperament is established for Hesper Wrenfield. The exchanges above cannot reliably determine whether the subject was fearful, defiant, calm, confused, or merely represented so by a faulty hand.]

QUESTIONER: Last opportunity. Name the one who sent you.

HESPER WRENFIELD: You have my name.

QUESTIONER: That is not what was asked.

HESPER WRENFIELD: It is what remains.

The interrogation ends without confession, allegiance, or amended designation. Hesper Wrenfield remains entered as an Outrider and as a minor figure of the Ashen Era.